



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Making a tough decision.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's backgrounds in a wider variety of communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about decision-making.
- I can organize points in an argument.
- I can speculate about things, people and events.

Ask your partner:

- What are the reasons that some people choose to go back to school later in life?
- Do you think that people should work at the same type of job for their whole life? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Sally and Vanessa discuss **pros and cons***

* "Pros and cons" are the positive and negative aspects, or advantages and disadvantages of a situation.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** So ... I'm dying to know. What is this decision you have to make?
- Sally:** I think I want to go back to school.
- Vanessa:** Really? Why?
- Sally:** I've been blogging for a while and I feel like I'm ready for a fresh start.
- Vanessa:** Hmm ... okay. Let's talk about the pros and cons.
- Sally:** Well, first, you know I love blogging but it could be exciting to do something new and different.
- Vanessa:** Yeah, you must be getting a bit tired of blogging.
- Sally:** Yeah, a bit. I'd like to try something new. What's more, I might enjoy doing something that doesn't involve working on a computer. I could do something a little more active.
- Vanessa:** I understand. It must be hard to work at a computer all day long. But do you really need to go back to school?
- Sally:** Well, my second point is that I really love learning. It might be fun to learn about something new. And I may meet some interesting people.
- Vanessa:** Okay. That's true. But it's so costly to go to school.
- Sally:** I know. That's the part that I need to come to terms with. I do still have some money left from the lottery winnings.
- Vanessa:** Are you sure that going to school is the best way to spend it?
- Sally:** No, I'm not sure! That's my dilemma! But it would be an investment in my future.
- Vanessa:** It's definitely something to think over.





Let's Practice!

How to use the discourse markers.

Instructions: Match the corresponding statements in a coherent way. Write the letter of the matching statement in the given spaces.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. Going back to school has been really hard. _____ | a. Therefore, I've been thinking about quitting and looking for something new. |
| 2. I feel I'm doing really good at my job. _____ | b. What is more, I have had to go back over many things I forgot. |
| 3. I've been thinking about going back to school. _____ | c. In spite of all the thought I've given it, I haven't been able to decide. |
| 4. My job has become difficult lately. _____ | d. In fact, I might start this coming semester. |
| 5. I'm not sure if I want to work or go back to school. _____ | e. However, I don't think I would be able to do this my whole life. |



Let's Practice!

It's time to make some decisions.

Instructions: Underline the word that correctly completes each sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I have a big decision / plan / option to make: it's either going back to school or working.
2. This is very important; we need to consider / plan / think twice about our decision.
3. She is considering / plan / decision going abroad.
4. We must take the risk / decision / planning if we want to make a decision now.
5. She said that going back to school was the best plan / option / planning for her.





Extension Activity

Research schools and programs.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On the Internet, research some different schools and programs that you might want to go to.
- Put the schools and programs in a list and order them from most interesting to least interesting.
- Be prepared to explain your choices.
- Share your list with a partner. Do they have any programs that you want to add to your list?

Self-Assessment

Yes
No

I talk about social activities and decision-making.

☐ ☐

I organize points in an argument.

☐ ☐

I speculate about things, people and events.

☐ ☐

I research schools and programs on the Internet.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to be dying to do something** (expression): to be eager to do something
e.g. I'm dying to know. What is this decision you have to make?
- **fresh start** (expression): a new opportunity to start something again
e.g. I'm starting school next month. I feel like I'm ready for a fresh start.
- **costly** (adjective): something that has a high price
e.g. I know it might be fun to learn something new, but it's so costly to go to school.
- **to come to terms with** (expression): to accept the outcome of a situation or an argument
e.g. There are many pros and cons of going back to school, so need to come to terms with them.
- **dilemma** (noun): a difficult or problematic situation in which a decision needs to be taken
e.g. I'm not sure if going to school is the best way to spend my money. That's my dilemma!
- **to think over** (verb): to consider a situation carefully
e.g. Going back to school would mean spending a lot of money, but it's also an investment in my future. It's definitely something to think over.



Learning Points

Organizing Points in an Argument

You use words or phrases to organize ideas in a piece of writing.

Discourse markers show how ideas are connected. They usually come at the beginning of a sentence.

Discourse markers can show a **connection** to what the writer is saying and what was just written. They can also show what the writer's **opinion** is about what is being discussed.

Look at the chart for some common discourse markers and their meanings:

Discourse Marker	Meaning
<i>However</i>	<i>But; Contrast</i>
<i>Therefore</i>	Logical consequence
<i>In spite of</i>	Emphasizing a contrast
<i>What is more</i>	Adding
<i>Of course</i>	Stating it is obvious
<i>In fact</i>	Emphasizing and adding

Examples:

- *In spite of the violence (or maybe because of it), young kids love cartoons and prefer watching them to anything else.*
- *What is more, it is known that young children in the U.S. watch between 25 and 52 hours of television per week.*
- *Therefore, we might be bringing up an extremely violent younger generation!*





Learning Points

Modal Verbs for Speculating

We can use these modal verbs (also called modals of deduction, speculation or certainty) when we want to make a guess about something. We choose the verb depending on how sure we are.

You can show you are speculating about something by using a modal, like *must*, *might*, *may* or *could*.

The modal verb is followed by the main verb in the base form. You do not use "to". Do not add "ing", "ed", or "s" to the verb.

These are formal structures.

Examples:

- *Yeah, you must be getting a bit tired of blogging.*
- *What's more, I might enjoy doing something that doesn't involve working on a computer.*
- *It might be fun to learn about something new.*
- *And I may meet some interesting people.*

